

man who wonders why he never got ahead has made it his own, to read over and over.

Spare a sigh for those who do not realize the failure-potential that is inherent in stealing—and do your bit for others by buying the library another copy.

Secure a copy for yourself, too. Once you have read *Compensation* three times, you will read it a hundred times. You will want it at your bedside. It is a *must* for people who want to understand themselves, understand the world and find wonderful peace of mind that will stay with them.

The Law of Compensation in action. Before we finish this chapter, we shall come back to that essay which is perhaps the most important ever written. Now I want to tell you a story in several parts. I know it is a true story. I lived it.

As you know, I have made mistakes and I have yielded at times to the wrong kind of emotions. Had I not learned from my mistakes I would not consider myself worthy of giving advice; but, very definitely, I have learned from them and built success and peace of mind upon my hard-won knowledge.

Well, there was a time, some decades ago, when I had been through a personal crisis and it “got” me. This was connected with an adventure which, while it brought me valuable experience, brought me little else. I found it necessary to make a fresh start financially, mentally and spiritually.

Being in the downtown business district of Atlanta, Georgia, I visited my friend and former business associate Mark Wooding. He recently had opened a large cafeteria right in the heart of the business section.

Mark told me his business was in serious difficulty. He had not taken into account the fact that downtown Atlanta business houses close early each evening—or at least they did in that era. After that early close of business, the district was as quiet as a graveyard.

The result was that he did splendidly at lunchtime, but had very few customers at the dinner hour when he had counted on making a good part of his income. Was there any way of persuading people to have dinner at his cafeteria? He hadn’t thought of any.

My mind had been filled with my own problems. But I had learned long before that when one cannot find the solution to his own problems, the best thing he can do is to look for someone with a greater problem and help him find its solu-